Floor and QA Voice Desk

A voice module for downtime, holds, handovers, and release checkpoints

CASE STUDY

What Was Delivered

The Module

A voice module that sits inside the plant's daily tools so floor teams and QA can speak downtime, quality holds, nonconformance actions, and shift handovers in the moment. The module converts what they say into clean, structured records with the required fields, and blocks hold and release mistakes by enforcing the exact checkpoint that must exist before the next step is allowed.

How It Behaves When It Is Not Sure

If the module is missing a key detail like line, machine ID, lot number, pallet range, severity level, or hold scope, it does not log a half entry. It asks for the missing detail right then. If the caller cannot provide it, the module saves the draft as incomplete, notifies the right owner, and routes it to the correct queue so the record gets completed before it becomes a blind spot.

Update Notifications That Were Delivered

When a hold rule, disposition rule, downtime classification tree, or release checkpoint changes, the module sends a notification to the roles affected. It does this based on what the person asked or logged earlier, so the people who actually use that rule get alerted, not the whole plant. The notification includes what changed and points to the updated section so teams do not keep following last month's version during a shift.

Who It Serves

Line leads, operators, QA techs, sanitation supervisors, maintenance techs, shipping leads, plant supervisors, EHS, and quality leadership, plus the support roles who approve and audit holds and releases.

Client Snapshot

A US-based beef processing and value-added meat company running multiple plants with high-volume, shift-based production, where quality and food safety decisions must be consistent and defensible.

Teams Involved

Line leads, QA techs, sanitation supervisors, maintenance techs, warehouse shipping leads, plant supervisors, EHS, and quality leadership.

- A production reporting tool where downtime was often updated after the fact
- A quality hold and deviation process that depended on notes and memory in the moment
- Maintenance tickets created late when people had time to type
- Shift handovers that were verbal and inconsistent

The problem was not missing tools. The problem was missing structure at the moment decisions were made.

Where the Problem Showed Up

1

Downtime Gets Logged Too Late

A feeder jam happens on Line 3. The line restarts. At end of shift, the downtime reason is typed as "other," and the duration is guessed.

2

A Quality Hold Gets Created, But the Record Is Thin

QA places a hold, but the hold record misses severity, pallet range, quarantine scope, or who was notified. Shipping later asks what is actually blocked.

3

Hold and Release Rules Get Applied Differently by Shift

A deviation happens and one shift holds product while another shift reworks it, because they are using different interpretations of the same rule.

4

Shift Handover Loses Open Issues

Open defects, rework queues, and "watch this machine" details get lost between night shift and day shift, causing repeated checks and repeated failures.

The Pattern We Saw

Two Sources Created Most of the Production Noise

Delayed Reporting

Records were built from memory

Inconsistent Classification

"Other" swallowed the real root cause

Training and reminders did not solve it because the floor does not have time for typing and searching when the line is running.

What We Delivered

The Product: Floor and QA Voice Desk Module

What It Does, in Plain Terms

Captures the update by voice while the event is still fresh

What It Does, in Plain Terms

Forces the required fields so records are complete

What It Does, in Plain Terms

Writes the record into the system the plant already uses

What It Does, in Plain Terms

Blocks release and shipment-impacting moves if the checkpoint is missing

What It Does, in Plain Terms

Keeps a replay trail so "who logged this, and why" is answerable later

What It Does Not Do

It does not allow incomplete holds, vague downtime, or release actions that cannot be defended.

Where It Sits in Their World

Surfaces

- Mobile app for QA and floor leads
- Shared kiosk mode in QA or production office
- Optional supervisor view in Teams for approvals

Integrations

- Production reporting tool or MES
- Quality system or hold log
- Maintenance ticketing
- Shift handover log tool
- Inventory or lot tracking if the plant uses it

What It Writes Back

- Downtime records mapped into the reason tree
- Hold records with severity, pallet scope, quarantine details, and notifications
- CAPA tasks or corrective actions when required
- Maintenance tickets with machine and symptom details
- Shift handover records with blockers, open defects, and assigned owners

How People Actually Use It

Downtime Log

"Downtime on Line 3, Machine 12, feeder jam, 18 minutes, restarted, watching."

The module forces any missing field, maps it into the reason tree, and logs it immediately.

Quality Hold

"Hold Lot 8821, surface defect, severity major, quarantine pallets 4 to 9, notify QA lead."

The module writes the hold record with pallet range and routes notification.

Shift Handover

"Handover. Line 2 has rework queue for Lot 7740. Check metal detector sensitivity at start. Open maintenance ticket for slicer vibration."

The module writes the handover record, assigns owners, and sets due times.

Release Block

"Can we load Lot 8821?"

If hold is active or release checkpoint is missing, the module blocks the step and points to what must be completed first.

Phases the Client Approved

1. Downtime Voice Logging First
2. QA Hold and Deviation Voice Capture Next
3. Shift Handover Voice Capture Next
4. Hold and Release Checkpoints After That
5. Replay Trail and Audit Views Throughout

Current Status

Completed

- Downtime voice capture with reason tree mapping
- QA hold creation with required fields
- Shift handover records with owners and due times
- Block and notify behaviour when checkpoints are missing
- Replay trail for audit and review

Underway

- Refining reason tree mapping so plant-specific terms map correctly
- Reducing the number of questions asked while still capturing required fields
- Aligning release checkpoints with each site's approval practice

Next

- Expand to more plants with different machine naming and noise levels
- Add monitoring for repeat downtime causes and repeat hold patterns
- Broaden update notifications so when rules change, the right roles get pinged based on their earlier usage history

Proof Gates

Incomplete Records Blocked

If line, machine, lot, severity, or pallet scope is missing, the record cannot be marked complete

No Vague Downtime

If the downtime reason cannot be mapped, it cannot be logged as "other" without supervisor confirmation

Release Blocked Without Checkpoint

If hold release checkpoint is missing, shipment-impacting steps are blocked

Ownership Enforced

If ownership is unclear, it notifies the supervisor queue

Full Traceability

Every record is traceable to who spoke, when, and what fields were captured

What We Learned

> The biggest change came from making "other" harder to use. It forced real root causes to show up.

Holds Became Calmer

Once the record had pallet scope and severity every time.

Shift Handover Transformed

Became a structured record, not a verbal memory test.

Talk to Us

connect via neil.voishift@klyrr.com

Do your downtime reasons get typed at end of shift and land as "other"?

Do holds lack the details shipping and supervisors need?

Do handovers lose open defects and rework queues?

Do release mistakes happen because the checkpoint was never captured cleanly?

We will map one line workflow, deploy the Floor and QA Voice Desk inside your plant tools, and enforce hold and release checkpoints so the floor can move fast without losing control.